149 Tiny Speakers, One Very Loud Wall

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What happens if you link 149 tiny speakers together? A team at WIRED found out by building a literal wall of sound at its London office. The speakers were IKEA's Kallsup, a $10 **Bluetooth** speaker launched in April. Each one is a 2.75-inch cube in bright white, green, or pink, and IKEA had said it might be possible to chain 100 of them.

WIRED asked IKEA's headquarters in Almhult if it could try. IKEA agreed and raised the challenge, saying it might be possible to link up to 150 without breaking the connection, so it sent 150 speakers. "No one has ever tried this, though," an IKEA spokesperson said. "We haven't." One speaker was damaged in shipping and rattled, so the team worked with 149.

Chaining them was simple. After pairing one Kallsup with an iPhone 16 Pro, the team powered on another cube while music played and held down Play until a chime signaled "multi-speaker" mode. Linking all the speakers took about 30 minutes.

Each Kallsup has a single 1.8-inch **driver** powered by a 3-watt **amplifier**, with **Bluetooth** 5.3 support and no separate **tweeter** or **woofer**. On its own, it sounds fine, though a bit tinny, and works well as a small desktop or bedside speaker. With 149 **drivers**, the combined surface area roughly equals one enormous 22-inch **driver**, and the combined rated output is 447 watts.

At 100 speakers, the sound was seriously loud, like a fire alarm rather than a hi-fi system. At maximum volume with all 149, the team could not hear each other speak and could feel vibrations, and the music lost clarity. Still, the chain kept working. The experiment fell well short of the world record of 1,500 speakers set by Majority Audio in March 2026. At modest volumes, the wall sounded more composed, though the music lacked depth. A wall costs $1,490, and WIRED does not recommend buying one. Its lesson was simple: for high-quality audio, buy a better speaker. For $10, the Kallsup is simple, easy to chain, and hard to fault.

Word Treasure

driver -- The part inside a speaker that vibrates to make sound.

amplifier -- The part that makes an audio signal stronger so the sound is louder.

tweeter -- A small speaker part that makes high sounds.

woofer -- A speaker part that makes low, deep sounds.

Bluetooth -- A wireless way for devices such as phones and speakers to connect over a short distance.

Background you need

A Bluetooth speaker is a small speaker that plays music sent wirelessly from a phone or another device, without a cable.

A driver is the part inside a speaker that vibrates to make sound, and an amplifier boosts the signal so the sound comes out louder.

Chaining speakers means linking many of them so they all play the same music at once, which can make the sound much louder but does not always make it sound better.

The experiment tested how far a chain of cheap speakers could go before the connection broke.

Break it down

LEAD: A WIRED team built a literal wall of sound from 149 tiny IKEA speakers
KEY EVENT: Chaining IKEA Kallsup speakers at WIRED's London office
+- WHO: A team at WIRED, with speakers sent by IKEA
+- HOW: Pair one speaker with an iPhone, then power on each new cube and hold Play until a chime signals multi-speaker mode
+- TIME: Linking all the speakers took about 30 minutes
EVIDENCE: At maximum volume with all 149, the team could not hear each other speak and could feel vibrations
CONTEXT: The experiment fell well short of the world record of 1,500 speakers set by Majority Audio
CONCLUSION: For high-quality audio, buy a better speaker; for $10, the Kallsup is simple, easy to chain, and hard to fault

Why it matters

The experiment shows that linking many cheap gadgets can produce an eye-catching result, but more of something is not the same as better quality, a useful lesson when choosing tech.

Test what you remember

1. How many speakers did the team end up using?

(A) 100
(B) 1,500
(C) 149
(D) 150

2. Why did the team work with 149 speakers instead of 150?

(A) One speaker ran out of battery
(B) One speaker was damaged in shipping and rattled
(C) The iPhone could only pair with 149
(D) IKEA only sent 149

3. How long did linking all the speakers take?

(A) About 30 minutes
(B) About a full day
(C) About 2 hours
(D) About 10 minutes

4. What was the combined rated output of all 149 speakers?

(A) 22 watts
(B) 3 watts
(C) 1,490 watts
(D) 447 watts

5. What world record did the experiment fall well short of?

(A) 150 speakers
(B) 1,500 speakers set by Majority Audio
(C) A 22-inch driver
(D) 100 speakers

6. What does WIRED recommend for high-quality audio?

(A) Buy 149 Kallsups
(B) Buy a bigger iPhone
(C) Buy a better speaker
(D) Buy a fire alarm

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. An IKEA spokesperson: No one had ever tried chaining this many Kallsup speakers before.

2. WIRED: A wall of 149 speakers is not worth buying; for high-quality audio, buy a better speaker.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):